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PHASE 1 ROWBOROUGH: OPEN SPACE STRATEGY

Client

Vistry and Taylor Wimpey

Project

Land North of the A420,

South Marston and Rowborough NEV, Swindons

Date

August 2025

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-	Final	CEH/25/07/25	BC/28/07/25
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1.0 INTRODUCTION

Context

1.1 This Phase 1 Rowborough: Open Space Strategy has been produced by FPCR Environment and Design Ltd. on behalf of Vistry and Taylor Wimpey (VTW).

1.2 The Open Space Strategy is for the development at South Marston and Rowborough, in the context of, and with reference to, the wider Eastern Villages development site (planning reference S/OUT/13/1555).

1.3 An Open Space Strategy is required prior to the submission of the first Reserved Matters Application on each Phase, or as part of the first Reserved Matters Application for that Phase.

1.4 This Open Space Strategy relates solely to land within Phase 1, Rowborough Central as shown in 'orange' below from the Phasing Details (June 2023).

Figure A: Phases of the Development

(Extract from, Land North of the A420, South Marston and Rowborough, NEV, Swindon Condition 6 of OPP OUT/13/1555, Phasing Details, June 2023 update)

2.0 REQUIREMENTS

Section 106

2.1 The submission of a strategy for the design provision and laying out of the Open Space is in accordance with the specification under Part B, Appendix 6, of the s106, which states the following:

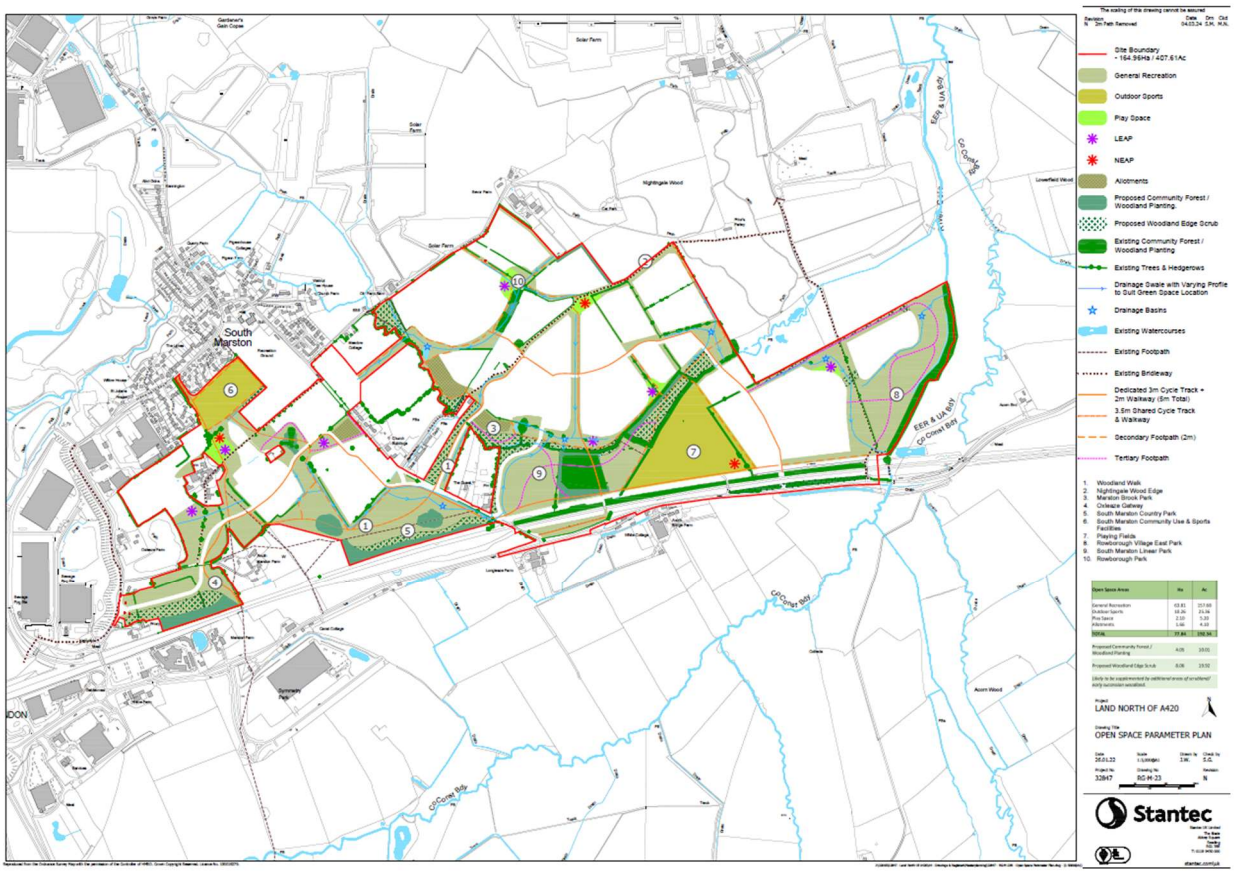
"The Open Space Strategy shall contain details of the following:

1. *Location and quantity of each type of open space being provided on site within each Phase:*
   a) *general recreation*
   b) *Formal Children's Play - LEAPs and NEAP and their location*
   c) *Allotments*
   d) *SuDs/Drainage elements*
   e) *Outdoor Sports*
   f) *environmental constraints*
   g) *Community Forest/woodland planting*
2. *Proposed future management and ownership of the open space*
3. *Arrangements for ensuring that the Management Company or Management Entity are provided with a full pack of information about the Open Space to be transferred to the Management Company or Management Entity prior to its transfer which for the avoidance of doubt must contain the most- up-to date Institute of Play Inspectors International Inspection Certification for the LEAPs and NEAPs integral to that specific transfer including all post construction and regular inspections prior to transfer as built plan drawings Health and safety file from CDM Regulations surveys/utilities*
4. *Management of drainage elements associated with the SuDS infrastructure contained within the relevant open space*
5. *Detailed schedule for future maintenance standards of all open space (and sports hub if applicable).*"

3.0 PROVISION

Location and quantity of each type of open space

3.1 As required by the Section 106, a site wide Open Space Parameter Plan has been prepared (see below). The Open Space Parameter Plan identifies the different open space types and the location of each type across all phases.



Open Space Parameter Plan

3.2 Table 1 below summarises the open space types and provision within Phase 1, Rowborough.

Table 1

Phase 1 Rowborough Open Space Type	Provision & Location	Commentary
Play Space	**2 LEAPs** *Both located within the South Marston Brook Park.* ***L3*** *LEAP located to the south close to development area edge* ***L4*** *LEAP located to the east close to development area edge*	LEAP (Local equipped areas for play). Minimum activity zone of 400m2 for each LEAP).

Phase 1 Rowborough Open Space Type	Provision & Location	Commentary
	1 NEAP *N2 located to the north of Rowborough Village Neighbourhood Park on a Nightingale Wood link, close to Primary School*	NEAP (Neighbourhood equipped areas for play) (Minimum activity zone of 1000m2 comprising an area for play equipment and structures
Allotments	**Allotments** *2 parcels (A2 and A3) within the South Marston Brook Park*	Comprises land for allotments (min 20 half sized plots) with access, services and parking.
General Recreation	*Around the built development parcels and primarily within the South Marston Brook Park and South Marston Linear Park*	Green infrastructure to include retained habitats, areas of new planting (woodland, native shrub, hedgerows and individual trees); grassland creation, surface water drainage (swales and basins), existing rights of way and new recreational routes including a dedicated 3m cycle track and 2m walkway and footpaths.
Community Forest/Woodland Planting	*Located within General Recreation Area*	New native woodland and tree planting *to strengthen existing features.*
Woodland Edge/Scrub	*Located within General Recreation Area*	New native woodland edge/scrub mixes *to strengthen existing feature.*
SuDS Drainage Basins and Swales	*Located within General Recreation Area*	Drainage swales providing drainage and ecological benefits

Design Principles

3.3 The Strategic Design Code (SDC) provides the design intentions for the open space elements within Phase 1 Rowborough. Reserved matters applications for landscape will follow the guidance within the SDC.

South Marston Brook Park

3.4 The South Marston Brook Park extends around the southern edge of the built area and acts as a central multi functional recreation space for nearby residents. The park will be designed to

enhance the route of the South Marston Brook and will include informal recreation spaces and more formal provision including allotments. The park will be designed with a 'country park' character with timber materials used towards the edges in the more rural context, and metal used at the interfaces with the built development. Planting will include feature parkland trees along with a range of shrub and grassland creation.

Play Space

3.5 The design of the equipped play spaces will be in accordance with relevant good practice guidance to include, for example, Planning for Design & Outdoor Sport & Play (Fields in Trust).

NEAP (N2)

3.11 The Neighbourhood Equipped Area for Play (NEAP1) will be area of open space specifically designated, laid out and equipped mainly for older children but with play opportunities for younger children as well. The design of the equipped play space will be in accordance with relevant good practice guidance to include, for example, Planning for Design & Outdoor Sport & Play (Fields in Trust).

3.12 The NEAP will be designed to provide a stimulating and challenging play experience with a minimum of nine play experiences (equipment). Equipment will be chosen to provide opportunities for balancing, rocking, climbing, overhead activity, sliding, swinging, jumping, crawling, rotating, imaginative play, and social play.

3.13 The NEAP will comprise a minimum activity zone of 1000m2 comprising an area for play equipment and a hard-surfaced area of at least 465m2. A minimum buffer zone of 30 metres minimum depth should separate the activity zone and the boundary of the nearest property containing a dwelling.

3.14 Self-closing gates, seating, litter bins and cycle storage will be provided together with signage (e.g. indicating the area is for children's play and dogs are not welcome, contact details of facility operator and location of the nearest telephone). Boundaries to the NEAP will be well defined and recognisable by landscape design methods.

3.15 Perimeter fences are generally considered inappropriate although some fencing may be necessary if the facility is close to a road. If the NEAP is enclosed there should be two self-closing gates on opposite sides of the NEAP for easy access. If fencing is used, a height of 1 metre is suggested. Depending on location, there may need to be a barrier limiting the speed of a child entering or leaving the NEAP. Seating should be provided for accompanying adults and siblings along with one or more litter bins. The siting of equipment and features within the activity zone should be considered to preclude opportunities for overlooking nearby gardens and dwellings and potential loss of privacy and creation of nuisance.

LEAPs (L3 & L4)

3.16 The Locally Equipped Areas of Play are areas of open space specifically designated and laid out with features including equipment for children who are beginning to go out and play independently close to where they live and will be primarily for younger children. The design of the equipped play space will be in accordance with relevant good practice guidance to include, for example, Planning for Design & Outdoor Sport & Play (Fields in Trust).

3.17 The LEAPs will be designed to provide a stimulating and challenging play experience with a minimum of six play experiences (equipment). Equipment will be chosen to provide opportunities for balancing, rocking, climbing, overhead activity, sliding, swinging, jumping, crawling, rotating, imaginative play, and social play.

3.18 The LEAPs will comprise a minimum activity zone of 400m2. A buffer zone of 10 metres minimum depth normally should separate the activity zone and the boundary of the nearest property containing a dwelling. A minimum of 20 metres would normally be provided between the activity zone and the habitable room façade of the nearest dwelling.

3.19 Self-closing gates, seating, and litter bins will be provided together with signage (e.g. indicating the areas are for children's play and dogs are not welcome, contact details of facility operator and location of the nearest telephone). Boundaries to the LEAPs would be well defined and recognisable by landscape and or fencing treatment.

Allotments (A2 & A3)

3.20 The allotment provision will allow for 20 half size plots. An appropriate hard surfaced (e.g) stone dust path will be included through the centre of the plots with a turning head to allow access by a tracker with trailer. Paths between the plots will be 1.5m wide to allow disabled access with grass paths 600mm wide through the centre of each plot. The boundary of the allotments will be protected by a c2.4m high security fence with lockable gates. Any boundary hedges must be planted to accommodate future maintenance. The plots should be served by a water supply with water tanks throughout the plots as well as sewerage and electricity supply. An appropriate level car parking should also be provided with a hard surfaced area for future communal storage sheds/clubhouse.

3.21 The allotments will be easily accessible and orientated to maximise sunlight and not significantly overshadowed by trees and hedgerows and with a reasonable depth of standard topsoil.

General Recreation

3.22 This comprises retained habitats (e.g. trees, hedgerows and grassland), areas of new planting (e.g. Community Forest & Woodland Planting, woodland scrub/edge planting, hedgerows and individual trees); grassland creation (e.g. wildflower meadows, wet grassland area), and SuDs, (surface water drainage basins and swales). The design will focus on delivering native species that are common to this landscape, with a mix of plant types and grassland habitats to maximise biodiversity benefit. The design should ensure that the General Recreation area is multifunctional in that it offers, for example, benefits for biodiversity, landscape, recreation and health and well-being, and adaption to climate change.

4.0 MANAGEMENT & OWNERSHIP

Proposed future management and ownership of the open space.

4.1 It is expected that all of the Phase 1 Rowborough Open Space types will be managed by a Landscape Management Company. The Open Space Strategy does not preclude other

appropriate bodies such as the Local Planning Authority, the Parish Council, and Management Trusts from managing components of the Phase 1 Rowborough Open Space.

5.0 MANAGEMENT TRANSFER

Arrangements for ensuring that the Management Company or Management Entity are provided with a full pack of information about the Open Space to be transferred to the Management Company or Management Entity prior to its transfer.

5.1 There will be an appropriate mechanism in place between Taylor Wimpey and Vistry and the Landscape Management Company (or any other appropriate body taking on management responsibilities) as part of the transfer of the Open Space to the Landscape Management Company. This will include providing relevant information to the Landscape Management Company on the Open Space prior to its transfer.

6.0 MANAGEMENT – DRAINAGE ELEMENTS

Management of drainage elements associated with the SuDS infrastructure contained within the relevant open space.

6.1 It is expected that the Phase 1 Rowborough SuDS basins and swales will be managed by the Landscape Management Company (or any other appropriate body taking on management responsibilities)

7.0 MAINTENANCE

Detailed schedule for future maintenance standards of all open space

7.1 All Open Space types will be monitored by the Landscape Maintenance Contractor to allow for an appropriate refinement of the following maintenance regime which provides general maintenance standards.

Description of works **General Maintenance Standards**	**Years Active**					
	1	**2**	**3**	**4**	**5**	**6+**
Play Space (LEAPs & NEAP)						
Regular inspection of play equipment and a general maintenance check/record of all equipment, surfacing, fencing, furniture, gates and associated fittings, nuts, bolts and plugs. Particular attention should be paid to the safety of the play features, with all fixings and platforms secure and all individual play equipment sound and operational.	√	√	√	√	√	√
Regular litter clearance and sweep of the area should be undertaken. This will include emptying of any litterbins and the removal of litter, glass, stones, and any other debris from the play surfaces.	√	√	√	√	√	√

Description of works **General Maintenance Standards**	**Years Active**					
	1	**2**	**3**	**4**	**5**	**6+**
Allotments						
Regular inspection and on-going general maintenance of the facility.	√	√	√	√	√	√

Description of works **General Maintenance Standards**	**Years Active**					
	1	**2**	**3**	**4**	**5**	**6+**
General Recreation						
Existing Trees/Woodland Inspect trees/woodland annually and after storms. Undertake any resultant scheduled tree works outside of the bird breeding season as appropriate. Retain or remove arisings as appropriate	√	√	√	√	√	√
Existing Hedges Cut once annually in winter after fruiting on a rotational basis, i.e. 50% of hedges cut on year, the remainder cut the following year (outgrown hedgerows to be cut back to prevent overhanging of adjacent land uses where applicable). Remove arisings from site.	√	√	√	√	√	√
Community Forest/Woodland Planting/Woodland Edge/Scrub Planting						
During establishment ensure a 500mm radius around each tree is kept weed and grass free, inspect plant protection regularly and adjust or replace where damaged.	√	√	-	-	-	-
Remove tree protection once plants have established.	-	-	√	√	√	-
Carry out selective thinning, periodically to establish healthy, diverse woodland.	-	-	-	-	√	√
Inspect trees annually and after major storms. Undertake any resultant scheduled tree works outside of the bird breeding season as appropriate. Prune as required to achieve healthy growth and natural shape. Retain or remove arisings as appropriate.	√	√	√	√	√	√

Description of works **General Maintenance Standards**	**Years Active**					
	1	**2**	**3**	**4**	**5**	**6+**
Amenity (short mown) Grassland Types						
During establishment mow only when the grass reaches 75mm height and cut to 40mm. Remove arisings from first mow only.	√	√	√	√	√	√
Cut once monthly (March-October) to 50mm or lower. Distribute arisings evenly.	√	√	√	√	√	√
Meadow (longer) Grassland Types						
Control weed growth in year 1. 4 cuts in year 1 (March and again late May, and again September/October.) Cut to 50mm. Remove arisings by day 10.	√					
2 cuts per year. 1 cut late in March and 1 cut September/ October. Sward height 50mm. Remove arisings by day 10.		√	√	√	√	√
Re-sow worn patches and treat weeds with a suitable herbicide as required.	√	√				

Description of works **General Maintenance Standards**	**Years Active with Priority**					
	1	**2**	**3**	**4**	**5**	**6-20**
SuDs Drainage Elements						
General maintenance checks at regular intervals to check for any blockages/debris/fly tipping, which may affect or impede water flows. Large fly tipping items should be removed as soon as possible.	√	√	√	√	√	√

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